

KEXIN QUE

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EDUCATION

Graduate student, Northwestern University

Sept. 2023 — June 2028 (Expected)

Advisor: Dr. Dedre Gentner

BSc (Hons) Psychology, University of Bath

Oct. 2017 — June 2021

Graduated with First-class honors

Thesis project: People Infer Higher Reward from Less Probable Action: The Trade-off Reasoning between Reward and Probability in Action Understanding

Advisor: Dr. Shari Liu (Mentor), Dr. Elizabeth Spelke (Supervisor), Dr. Richard Joiner (Supervisor)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Analogical Reasoning, Number Learning, Number Syntax, Language and Cognition

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Student Research Fund, Department of Psychology, Northwestern University (\$1000)

Cognitive Science Conference Travel Grant, Northwestern University, 2024 (\$500)

PUBLICATIONS

Que, K., Gentner, D. (accepted by CogSci 2026). Using Analogical Comparison to Reveal the Structure of the Count List.

Que, K., Rips, L. (accepted by CogSci 2026). Two Distinct Processes in the Understanding of Number Word Structure.

Que, K., Gentner, D. (in prep). Analogical Comparison Supports Children's Acquisition of the Successor Principle.

Que, K., Zhang, Y., Christie, S. & Levine, S. (in prep). Cultural Similarities and Differences in the Emergence and Development of Children's Math Attitudes.

Zhang, Y., **Que, K.**, Christie, S. & Levine, S. (in prep). Enjoyment or Effort: Math Learning Goals and Decision Making in Two Cultures.

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, Tan, Z., Zhang, Y., & Christie, S. (2022). Analogy Use in Parental Explanation. *In Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 44, No. 44).

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, & Christie, S. (2022). On the Question of Children's Questions. *Early Childhood Development*, 1, 24-35. (in Mandarin)

PRESENTATIONS AND POSTERS

Que, K., & Rips, L. (2026 June). Why isn't "twenty-eight" "ten ten eight"? Talk accepted at the Biennial Conference on Experiments in Linguistic Meaning, University of Pennsylvania.

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2026). Using Analogical Comparison to Reveal the Structure of Numbers. Invited brownbag talk at the Developmental Psychology Program, University of Chicago.

Que, K., & Gentner, D. (2025). How do children come to understand numbers?. Poster presentation at the Developmental Sciences Cluster, Northwestern University.

Que, K., & Rips, L. (2025). Cross-linguistic Similarities and Differences in People's Understanding of the Structure of Number Words. Poster presentation at the 2025 Cognitive Science Society, San Francisco.

Que, K., Zhang, Y., Christie, & S., Levine, S. (2025). Family Math Attitudes and Children's Views on Effort and Enjoyment: Cultural Differences and Similarities. Poster presentation at the Society for Research in Child Development Conference, Minneapolis.

Zhang, Y., **Que, K.**, Levine, S. & Christie, S. (2024). Enjoyment or Effort: Math learning goals and decision making in two cultures. Poster presentation at the Cognitive Development Society Conference, Pasadena.

Srinivasan, A., Topaloglu, S., **Que, K.**, İleri, C., Küntay, A., Christie, S., Snedeker, J., & Spelke, E. (2024) Does language shape children's understanding of numerical concepts?. Talk presentation at the 14th annual Budapest CEU Conference on Cognitive Development, Budapest, Hungary.

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, & Christie, S. (2023). Explaining with Spontaneous Analogies. Invited talk at the 20th Biennial EARLI Conference, Thessaloniki, Greece.

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, Tan, Z., Zhang, Y., & Christie, S. (2022). Analogy Use in Parental Explanation. Talk presented at the 2022 Cognitive Science Society. (online)

Gao, Y., **Que, K.**, Tan, Z., Zhang, Y., & Christie, S. (2022). Analogy Use in Parental Explanation. Talk presented at the Analogical Minds seminar. (online)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Tsinghua Laboratory of Brain and Intelligence Nov. 2020 — June 2023
PI: Dr. Stella Christie *Tsinghua University*

- Led a cross-cultural study of family math attitudes and a cross-linguistic study of children's understanding of number words
- Contributed to the design, data collection, and analysis of a study on analogy generation and a cross-cultural study of families' use of relational language and children's analogical reasoning

Student Intern, Harvard Laboratory for Developmental Studies Aug. 2019 — Sept. 2020
PI: Dr. Elizabeth Spelke *Harvard University*

- Led a study on intuitive psychology
- Contributed to the design of projects on intuitive mathematics and geometry

Research Assistant, Speech, Language and Neuroscience Group July 2019 — Aug. 2019
PI: Dr. Xing Tian *NYU Shanghai*

- Contributed to the data collection for a study on speech production

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant Fall 2023 — Fall 2025
Social Psychology *Northwestern University*

- Social Psychology (Fall 2025, with Dr. Dan Molden); Developmental Psychology (Spring 2025, with Dr. Sara Broaders); Statistical Methods in Psychology (Fall 2024, with Dr. Mike Bailey); Learning,

Representation, and Reasoning (Spring 2024, with Dr. Dedre Gentner); Introduction to Neuroscience (Winter 2024, with Dr. Robin Nusslock)

Part-time Tutor

Educate.co

March 2018 — May 2019

Online

- Taught IGCSE Physics, A-level Mathematics, and Further Math lessons to high school students

Primary School Teacher

University of Bath's Volunteer Teaching Program

June 2018 — July 2018

DuoLun Second primary school, China

- Taught psychology classes to students from Grade 1 to Grade 5

OTHER EXPERIENCES

- Initiated and co-organized a writing workshop in the Child Cognition Center at Tsinghua University
- Managed and wrote articles for the social media account of the Child Cognition Center at Tsinghua University.
- Illustrated bilingual storybooks and translated content from English to Chinese at the Harvard College Children's Society.
- Led and organized the University of Bath's volunteer teaching program in Inner Mongolia, China

RESEARCH SKILLS

Designing experiment

PowerPoint, Keynote, Qualtrics, iMovie, and PsychoPy

Coding experiment

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Analyzing data

R, Excel, SPSS, and Excel